Adverbial Pronouns (Y & En)

To avoid the repetition of certain nouns of place and inanimate Indirect Objects (things/ideas) among others in a passage, we replace them with the adverbial pronouns **y** and **en**.

Source: Amazon_Mathew_Maudet

Pronoun Y

Usages of Pronoun Y

1. **To Replace Prepositions + Noun of Place**
   - The adverbial pronoun **Y** replaces **prepositions + noun of place**.
   - It is generally used with the geographical prepositions such as **à, en, dans, sur, chez, devant** (except the preposition 'de').
   - It is generally placed before the verb except in the imperative form and, in this case, Y is translated as **there** (as it replaces a noun of place).

Français	English
J'adore Paris. Je vais **à Paris** lundi. J'adore Paris. J'**y** vais lundi.	I love Paris. I'm going to Paris on Monday. I love Paris. I'm going there on Monday.
Elle voulait toujours s'installer en France. Elle habite **en France** maintenant. Elle voulait toujours s'installer en France. Elle **y** habite maintenant.	She always wanted to settle in France. She now lives in France. She always wanted to settle in France. She lives there now.
Il est **dans le salon.**	He is in the living room.

Il **y** est.	He is there.
Je pose le sac **sur la table.** J'**y** pose le sac.	I'm putting the bag on the table. I'm putting the bag there.
Tom travaille **dans une banque.** Tom **y** travaille.	Tom works in a bank. Tom works there.
La machine est **chez le dentiste.** La machine **y** est.	The machine is at the dentist's. The machine is there.

Note: Y cannot replace a phrase beginning **with the preposition de (from)**, even if it is a place being referred to. For example,

Ils vont **à la boulangerie** (They are going to the bakery).
Ils **y** vont (They are going there).

But,

Elle revient **de l'école** (She is coming back from the school).
Elle **en** revient (She is coming back from there).

2. In Sentences with Verbs + À + Inanimate Indirect Objects (Things/Ideas)

- Y is also used to replace **Inanimate Indirect Objects** preceded by verb + **à**.
- Y is rendered as **it** or **them** (singular/plural) and is placed before the verb mostly except in the Imperative form.

Français	English
Il obéit **aux lois**. Il **y** obéit.	He obeys the laws. He obeys them.
Anne répond incorrectement **aux questions**. Anne **y** répond incorrectement.	Anne answers the questions incorrectly. Anne answers them incorrectly.
Donald réfléchit souvent **à sa vie.** Donald **y** réfléchit souvent.	Donald often thinks about his life. Donald often thinks about it.
Je participe **à ce projet.** J'**y** participe.	I'm participating in this project. I'm participating in it.
J'écris souvent **à mes parents.** Je **leur** écris souvent.	I often write to my parents. I often write to them.
Elle pense **à sa relation avec lui.** Elle **y** pense.	She thinks about her relationship with him. She thinks about it.

3. Expressions with the Adverbial Pronoun ‘Y’

Français	English
Allons-y !	Let’s go!
On y va !	Let’s go / Let’s do it!
Il y a	There is / There are

Pronoun EN

- It is used to replace multiple grammatical entities such as a Noun of Place, Indefinite/Partitive Articles, Inanimate Indirect Object **after the preposition de**.
- It is mostly placed before the verb, **except in the imperative mood**.
- Its translation varies based on usage.

Usages of Pronoun EN

1. To Replace Preposition ‘De’ (From) + Noun of Place

Français	English
Elle revient **d'Inde.** Elle **en** revient.	She is returning from India. She is returning from there.
Nous arrivons **de Paris.** Nous **en** arrivons.	We are arriving from Paris. We are arriving from there.
Il vient de **Rennes.** Il **en** vient.	He is coming from Rennes. He is coming from there.

2. To Replace Indefinite / Partitive Article + Noun

Français	English
J’ai **du pain.** J**’en** ai.	I have some bread. I have some.
Il cherche **des idées.** Il **en** cherche.	He is looking for ideas. He is looking for some.
Tu veux **des pâtes ?** Oui, j**’en** veux bien.	Do you want pasta? Yes, I would like some.

3. With Expressions of Quantity

Français	English
J'achète cinq **bouteilles de vin**. J'**en** achète **cinq.**	I am buying five bottles of wine. I am buying five of them.
Vous avez **deux voitures ?** Oui, nous **en** avons **deux.**	You have two cars? Yes, we have two of them.
Ils ont **plusieurs montres**. Ils **en** ont **plusieurs.**	They have several watches. They have several of them.
Nous avons **une fille**. Moi aussi, j'en **ai une.**	We have a daughter. I have one too.
J'ai **quelques livres** de cet auteur. Oui, tu **en** as **quelques-uns.**	I have a few books by this author. Yes, you have a few of them.
Elle a **beaucoup d'argent.** Oui, elle **en** a **beaucoup.**	She has a lot of money. Yes, she has a lot of it.

4. With Verb Expressions That Use the Preposition 'De'

Français	English
Elle parle **de son voyage.** Elle **en** parle.	She talks about her journey. She talks about it.
Elle est fière **de ses accomplissements.** Oui, elle **en** est fière.	She is proud of her achievements. Yes, she is proud of them.
Tu as besoin **d'un stylo ?** Oui, j'**en** ai besoin.	Do you need a pen? Yes, I need it.
Qu'est-ce que tu penses **de cette décision ?** Qu'est-ce que tu **en** penses ?	What do you think of this decision? What do you think about it?

5. Some Useful Expressions with 'En'

Français	English
J'en ai marre !	I'm fed up.
J'en ai assez !	I have had enough.

J’en ai besoin.	I need it.
J’en ai envie.	I feel like it.
J’en rêve.	I dream about it.
Je lui en veux.	I am mad at him/her.
Je m’en vais.	I am leaving.
Ne t’en fais pas !	Don't worry !
J’en faible pour lui/elle.	I have a crush on him/her.